

Apply to be a Science Corps Fellow - Entry #3363

Name
Carlo Pasini
Email
carlo.pasini@usys.ethz.ch
Gender
Male
Residence: City (State), Country
Zürich, Switzerland
Nationality
Italian
When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD?
April 2026
Please tell us briefly about your university education (institution, city, country, year)
Bsc. in Biology at the University of Bologna, Bologna, Italy (2015-2018)
Msc. in Plant Science at the University of Milan and Université Grenoble Alpes (double degree program), Milan-Grenoble, Italy-France (2019-2021)
PhD in plant molecular biology, ETH Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland (2021-present)
Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow?
The main reason for my interest in this position is my desire to find greater purpose in my work. After dedicating the past 10 years to academic achievements, I would now like to reassess my priorities and contribute to society in a more tangible way. While I love working in science and specifically in a molecular biology lab, my research focuses on fundamental aspects of plant biology, which makes it difficult to see the real-world impact of our findings. In contrast, the impact of higher education on the future of young people is well documented and supported by ample evidence. Given the challenges that humanity is facing today, I believe there is a growing need for people with a STEM background who possess the curiosity and preparation necessary to address these issues. In addition to these intrinsic motivations, on a more practical level, I really enjoy teaching. Whenever I interact with people who are not experts in my field, whether it's children at a science fair or university students entering the lab for the first time, their enthusiasm and curiosity for science reignite my own passion and remind me why I chose this path in the first place. This position would allow me to further explore my passion for teaching, while also offering the opportunity to experience a different culture in a meaningful and immersive way.

Taken together, I believe the vision and values of Science Corps align with my own, and I would be excited to contribute my passion and knowledge to its mission.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science Corps Fellow.

During my PhD, I supported my supervisor in teaching molecular biology classes and supervised several bachelor's and master's students during their semester and thesis projects in our lab. These experiences helped me in learning how to explain complex scientific concepts clearly and how to adapt my communication style to different levels of understanding.

Outside of academia, I was actively involved in my local ice hockey team for many years, where I also helped coach the junior team. This role taught me how to connect with younger children, motivate them, and maintain their attention, skills that I believe are highly valuable in an educational setting.

In 2024, I participated in a year-long initiative organized by the American Society of Plant Biologists, where I contributed content to their blog. This included summaries of recent scientific publications, interviews with researchers, and other resources of interest to the plant biology community. It was a rewarding experience that helped me improve my science communication skills while deepening my understanding of the field.

Currently, I am also the vice president of a non-profit organization called Telejob, which organizes events for the members of our university's community, at the interface of academic research and industry. This role has strengthened my project management abilities, expanded my professional network, and allowed me to develop skills in marketing and fundraising.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Scientist in academia

Doing science in industry

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

My long-term plans are tied to my desire to live near my family in Italy. This naturally limits my career options to Italy and neighbouring countries such as Switzerland, France, Germany, and Austria. In the shorter term, I see myself continuing to work in science, potentially doing a postdoc in a more applied area of plant biology.

On a longer timeframe, I plan to transition into industry, primarily due to the lack of stability and the very few tenure-track positions available in academia. Ideally, I would like to work in a science-related industry, like manufacturers of scientific equipment, where I would still be in touch with the scientific community. A role that particularly interests me is that of a field applications scientist, as it would allow me to make good use of my academic background and network while also giving me a sense of purpose by assisting scientists on the technical side.

Please upload your CV (.pdf)

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How did you find out about Science Corps?

An email list in your institution

[Science Corps](#)